



Rating
Buy

North America
United States

Consumer
Consumer Staples

Company
**The Coca-Cola
Company**

Reuters
KO.N

Bloomberg
KO US

Exchange
NYS

Ticker
KO

Date
21 October 2025

Results

Price at 20 Oct 2025 (USD)	68.44
Price target	81.00
52-week range	73.90 - 60.81

Quick Take - KO's 3Q25 results

How do we expect the market to react?

We view today's results and updated forward commentary from KO as positive and thus expect a favorable market reaction. Unit Case Sales in the quarter were +1% (vs. DBE 0.5% and buy-side expectations of ~flat, in our view). Moreover, organic sales grew +6% (DBE: +4.6%/Street: +4.8%), reflecting flat concentrate sales volume (DBE: +0.3%) and +6% price/mix (DBE: +4.4%). Overall, this led to a ~+1% beat on operating income vs. both DBE and Street, and a ~+5% beat on EPS (\$0.82 vs. DBE: \$0.78/Street: \$0.78), despite slightly softer gross margins (61.0% vs. DBE: 61.2%/Street: 61.4%).

Looking forward, KO's full-year FY25 outlook goes more or less unchanged. However, following strong FCF in the quarter, KO now expects full-year FCF of at least \$9.8 billion (\$9.5 billion prior; DBE: \$9.802 billion). Separately, KO also announced a definitive agreement to rebrand a controlling interest in Coca-Cola Beverages Africa to Coca-Cola HBC AG (generating \$1.3 billion in cash to KO; to be completed by the end of 2026), furthering the company's progression to a predominantly asset-light supply model. The company also sees a "slight" FX tailwind in FY26 on both total company sales and EPS, based on current rates and KO's hedged positions.

Into 4Q, we expect likely sequential deceleration in unit case sales momentum (noting more difficult year-over-year comparisons); however, we are nonetheless encouraged by what we see as likely improved momentum exiting 3Q vs. the company's prior commentary entering September.

KO will host a conference call with investors at 8:30am ET today to review results in more detail.

How do reported results compare with expectations?

KO reported 3Q25 EPS of \$0.82 vs. DBE: \$0.78/Street: \$0.78. Organic sales grew +6% (DBE: +4.6%/Street: +4.8%), reflecting flat concentrate sales volume (DBE: +0.3%) and +6% price/mix (DBE: +4.4%); unit case sales were +1% (DBE: +0.5%). Gross margin of 61.0% (DBE: 61.2%/Street: 61.4%) was down ~10 bps YOY. Overall operating income of \$3.957 billion was +0.8% ahead of DBE and +1.2% above the Street. Consolidated operating margins were 31.9% (DBE: 31.3%/Street: 31.4%).

Valuation & Risks

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By region, the organic revenue in EMEA was +7% (DBe: +6.5%/Street: +6.1%); Latin America was +4% (DBe: +12.5%/Street: +8.3%); North America was +4% (DBe: +2.5%/Street: +3.2%); Asia Pacific was +7% (DBe: +1.5%/Street: +5.0%); Bottling was +7% (DBe: +1.5%/Street: +2.5%); and Corporate was +65% (DBe: +20%).

Segment operating margins were EMEA at 41.3% (DBe: 41.0%/Street: 41.3%); Latin America at 62.2% (DBe: 62.9%/Street: 62.2%); North America at 29.3% (DBe: 29.7%/Street: 29.3%); Asia Pacific at 36.8% (DBe: 36.7%/Street: 36.8%); and Bottling at 5.3% (DBe: 6.6%/Street: 5.3%).

How has the company's outlook changed?

KO largely reaffirmed FY25 guidance as described below:

- Organic growth of +5% to +6% (unchanged; vs. DBe: +5.2%/Street: +5.3%), a -2% to -1% currency headwind (unchanged; DBe: -0.9%) based on the current rates which includes the impact of hedged positions, and -1% M&A headwind (unchanged; DBe: -0.8%). This implies comparable revenue of \$47.835-\$48.773 billion (unchanged) vs. DBe: \$48.521 billion/Street: \$48.391 billion.
- Comparable EPS growth of ~+3% (unchanged), which implies \$2.97 vs. DBe: \$2.98/Street: \$2.98. EPS guidance reflects +8% currency-neutral growth, a -5% FX headwind, and a -1% M&A headwind.
- Effective tax rate of 20.7% (20.8% prior). This does not include the impact of ongoing tax litigation with the U.S. Internal Revenue Service, if the company were not to prevail.
- FCF of at least \$9.8 billion (\$9.5 billion prior; DBe: \$9.802 billion/Street: \$5.134 billion) with cash flow from operations of \$11.7 billion (unchanged) and capex of ~\$2.2 billion (unchanged). Guidance and DBe presented here for cash from operations and FCF exclude the \$6.069 billion fairlife contingent consideration payment.

Implied guidance for 4Q is as follows:

- Organic Growth of +3.0%-7.1% vs. DBe: +5.1%/Street: +5.4%
- Comparable EPS of \$0.55 vs. DBe: \$0.60/Street: \$0.60

2026 Considerations:

- Both topline and comparable EPS are expected to include slight FX tailwinds based on the current rates and hedged positions



Consumer Staples
The Coca-Cola Company

Figure 1: KO 3Q25 Highlights

INCOME STATEMENT							
	3Q25	3Q24	chg.	DB Est.	Delta	Street	Delta
Organic growth	6.0%	9.0%	-300 bps	4.6%	136 bps	4.8%	120 bps
Comparable Revenue	\$12,412	\$11,949	3.9%	\$12,534	(1.0%)	\$12,435	(0.2%)
Cost of Goods Sold	4,837	4,642	4.2%	4,869	(0.7%)	4,799	0.8%
Gross Profit	7,575	7,307	3.7%	7,665	(1.2%)	7,636	(0.8%)
SG&A	3,618	3,636	(0.5%)	3,738	(3.2%)	3,728	(2.9%)
Operating Income	3,957	3,671	7.8%	3,927	0.8%	3,908	1.2%
Net Interest Expense	212	168	26.2%	254	(16.5%)	255	(16.7%)
Equity (income) loss	(637)	(537)	18.6%	(548)	16.2%	(537)	18.6%
Other (income) loss	(69)	(64)	7.8%	(25)	176.0%	(48)	44.9%
Pretax Income	4,451	4,104	8.5%	4,246	4.8%	4,239	5.0%
Taxes	913	755	20.9%	883	3.4%	886	3.1%
Noncontrolling Interest	(6)	2	(400.0%)	8	(175.0%)	(18)	(65.7%)
Net Income (Comparable)	3,544	3,347	5.9%	3,355	5.6%	3,371	5.1%
Diluted EPS - Comparable	\$0.82	\$0.77	6.1%	\$0.78	5.6%	\$0.78	5.1%
Diluted Shares Outstanding	4,313	4,323	(0.2%)	4,312	0.0%		
MARGIN ANALYSIS							
	3Q25	3Q24	chg.	DB Est.	Delta	Street	Delta
Gross Margin	61.0%	61.2%	-12 bps	61.2%	-12 bps	61.4%	-38 bps
SG&A Ratio	29.1%	30.4%	-128 bps	29.8%	-67 bps	30.0%	-83 bps
Operating Margin	31.9%	30.7%	116 bps	31.3%	55 bps	31.4%	45 bps
Pretax Margin	35.9%	34.3%	151 bps	33.9%	198 bps	34.1%	177 bps
Tax Rate	20.5%	18.4%	212 bps	20.8%	-29 bps	20.9%	-38 bps
Net Margin	28.6%	28.0%	54 bps	26.8%	179 bps	27.1%	145 bps
COMPARABLE REVENUE BY SEGMENT							
EMEA	2,984	2,740	8.9%	2,973	0.4%	2,720	9.7%
Latin America	1,563	1,671	(6.5%)	1,813	(13.8%)	1,734	(9.9%)
North America	5,249	5,042	4.1%	5,168	1.6%	5,204	0.9%
Asia Pacific	1,489	1,411	5.5%	1,425	4.5%	1,455	2.4%
Bottling Investments	1,346	1,316	2.3%	1,329	1.3%	1,337	0.7%
Corporate	34	21	61.9%	25	34.9%	26	33.1%
Eliminations	(253)	(252)	0.4%	(199)	26.9%	(40)	528.2%
Total Comparable Revenue	12,412	11,949	3.9%	12,534	(1.0%)	12,435	(0.2%)
OPERATING PROFIT BY SEGMENT							
EMEA	1,081	1,014	6.6%	1,219	(11.3%)	1,124	(3.8%)
Latin America	887	1,053	(15.8%)	1,141	(22.2%)	1,079	(17.8%)
North America	1,640	1,480	10.8%	1,533	7.0%	1,527	7.4%
Asia Pacific	504	511	(1.4%)	523	(3.7%)	535	(5.8%)
Bottling Investments	58	41	41.5%	88	(34.0%)	71	(18.9%)
Corporate / Eliminations	(213)	(428)	(50.2%)	(577)	(63.1%)	(428)	(50.3%)
Total Operating Profit	3,957	3,671	7.8%	3,927	0.8%	3,908	1.2%
SEGMENT OPERATING MARGIN							
EMEA	36.2%	37.0%	(78 bps)	41.0%	(478 bps)	41.3%	(509 bps)
Latin America	56.7%	63.0%	(627 bps)	62.9%	(617 bps)	62.2%	(547 bps)
North America	31.2%	29.4%	189 bps	29.7%	159 bps	29.3%	190 bps
Asia Pacific	33.8%	36.2%	(237 bps)	36.7%	(287 bps)	36.8%	(296 bps)
Bottling Investments	4.3%	3.1%	119 bps	6.6%	(231 bps)	5.3%	(104 bps)
Total	31.9%	30.7%	116 bps	31.3%	55 bps	31.4%	45 bps
COMPARABLE SALES DERIVATION (Actual)							
	Volume	Price/Mix	Organic	M&A/Other	FX	Sales	
EMEA	3.0%	4.0%	7.0%	0.0%	2.0%	8.9%	
Latin America	(3.0%)	7.0%	4.0%	0.0%	(11.0%)	(6.5%)	
North America	(2.0%)	6.0%	4.0%	0.0%	0.0%	4.1%	
Asia Pacific	(1.0%)	8.0%	7.0%	0.0%	(1.0%)	5.5%	
Bottling Investments	5.0%	1.0%	7.0%	(2.0%)	(2.0%)	2.3%	
Corporate	NA	NA	65.0%	0.0%	(2.0%)	61.9%	
Total	0.0%	6.0%	6.0%	0.0%	(1.0%)	3.9%	
Note: Volume from Concentrate Sales. M&A/Other includes acquisitions/divestitures/structural items/accounting changes. Organic growth is not selling-day adjuste							
COMPARABLE SALES DERIVATION (DBe)							
	Volume	Price/Mix	Organic	M&A/Other	FX	Sales	
EMEA	2.0%	4.5%	6.5%	0.0%	2.0%	8.5%	
Latin America	(0.5%)	13.0%	12.5%	0.0%	(4.0%)	8.5%	
North America	(0.5%)	3.0%	2.5%	0.0%	0.0%	2.5%	
Asia Pacific	(0.5%)	2.0%	1.5%	0.0%	(0.5%)	1.0%	
Bottling Investments	(0.5%)	2.0%	1.5%	0.0%	(0.5%)	1.0%	
Corporate	NA	NA	20.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20.0%	
Total	0.3%	4.4%	4.6%	0.5%	(0.2%)	4.9%	

Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Company filings, Deutsche Bank estimates and analysis



Appendix 1

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*Other information available upon request

Disclosure checklist			
Company	Ticker	Recent price*	Disclosure
The Coca-Cola Company	KO.N	68.44 (USD) 20 Oct 2025	2, 7, 8, 14, 15, 24, 26

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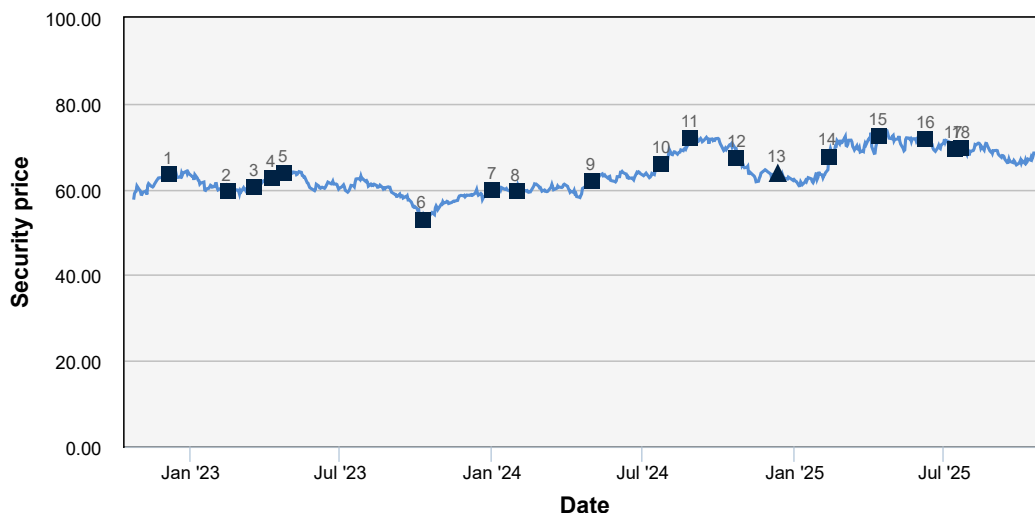
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Historical recommendations and target price: The Coca-Cola Company (KO.N)

(as of 10/20/2025)



Current Recommendations

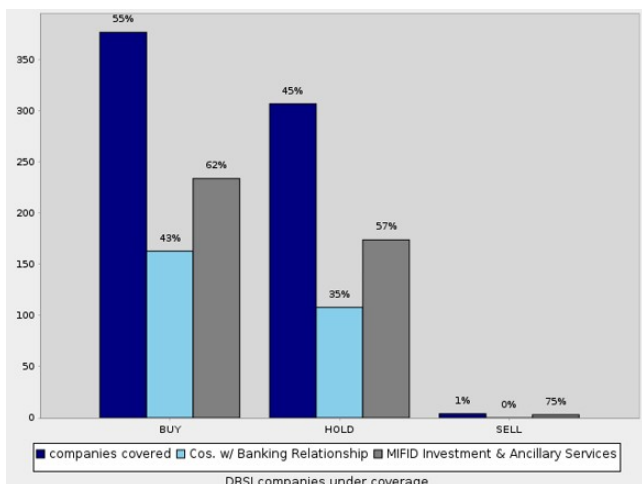
Buy
 Hold
 Sell
 Not Rated
 Suspended Rating

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1.	12/06/2022	Hold, Target Price Change USD 62.00, Current Price USD 63.44 Stephen Powers	10.	07/24/2024	Hold, Target Price Change USD 65.00, Current Price USD 65.81 Stephen Powers
2.	02/15/2023	Hold, Target Price Change USD 63.00, Current Price USD 59.59 Stephen Powers	11.	08/29/2024	Hold, Target Price Change USD 69.00, Current Price USD 72.05 Stephen Powers
3.	03/20/2023	Hold, Target Price Change USD 60.00, Current Price USD 60.60 Stephen Powers	12.	10/24/2024	Hold, Target Price Change USD 68.00, Current Price USD 67.30 Stephen Powers
4.	04/10/2023	Hold, Target Price Change USD 61.00, Current Price USD 62.69 Stephen Powers	13.	12/12/2024	Upgraded to Buy, Target Price Change USD 70.00, Current Price USD 63.84 Stephen Powers
5.	04/25/2023	Hold, Target Price Change USD 63.00, Current Price USD 63.85 Stephen Powers	14.	02/11/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 75.00, Current Price USD 67.60 Stephen Powers
6.	10/09/2023	Hold, Target Price Change USD 60.00, Current Price USD 52.88 Stephen Powers	15.	04/14/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 80.00, Current Price USD 72.45 Stephen Powers
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9.	05/01/2024	Hold, Target Price Change USD 64.00, Current Price USD 61.93 Stephen Powers	18.	07/22/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 81.00, Current Price USD 69.66 Stephen Powers



Equity rating dispersion and banking relationships



Equity Rating and Dispersion Key

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